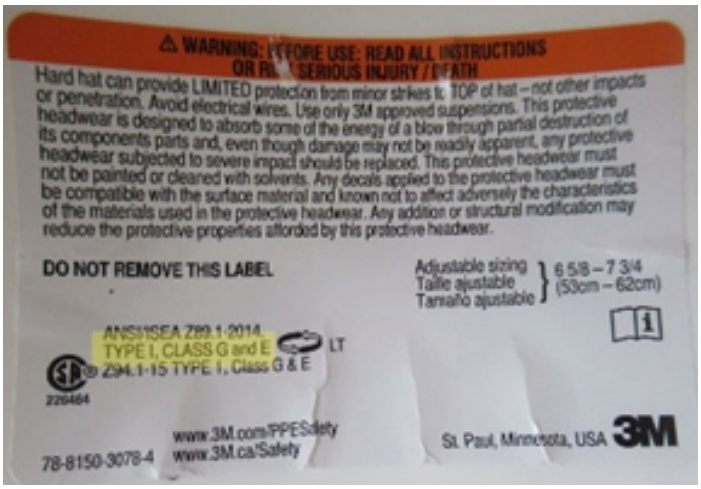
HARD HEAD OR HARD HAT

Hard hats are an important part of our PPE ensemble. As with all PPE, they should not be the first line of defense from overhead hazards. Controlled Access Zones, toe boards, canopies or covers, and housekeeping operations should always take precedence over PPE as a primary protection from overhead hazards.

Not all hard head coverings qualify as a hard hat. Hard hats must meet the ANSI Z89.1 standard. Bump caps and some offshoot manufacturers do not meet this standard. For safety, always make sure the hard hat you buy meets the Z89.1 Standard.

A **Type I** hard hat is designed to protect against blows to the top of the head only.

A **Type II** hard hat is designed to protect against blows to the top of the head and sides of the head. Type II hard hats are becoming more common, and many general contractors are now requiring Type II on their jobsites. OSHA recommends Type II hard hats for construction workers.



Class G (General) is rated at 2,200 volts (phase to ground). Class G is great, even for most electricians.

Class E (Electrical) is rated at 20,000 volts (phase to ground). Linemen may need Class E.

Class C (Conductive) does not provide protection against contact with electrical hazards.

LT has been tested in low temperatures; **HT** has been tested in high temperatures.

If you prefer wearing your hard hat backward, it needs the reversible symbol.

Properly Storing and Evaluating Head Protection

- Inspect the outer shell for cracks, dents, or other signs of damage. Run your fingers over the surface to check for any irregularities.
- Examine the suspension system (headband and chin strap) for wear and tear, ensuring it is securely attached to the shell and free from damage, and inspect interior cushioning for wear or compression.
- Look for labels and certification marks inside the head protection. Note: only head protection with a reverse-wearing label or mark can be worn in reverse.
- Check for proper fit. Before using head protection, ensure it fits comfortably and securely. Adjust the suspension system to achieve a snug fit without excessive pressure points. Head protection should not be too loose or too tight.
- Any hard hat should be discarded when it is impacted, if there are any signs of damage, degradation, or if the service life span is exceeded. If head protection has experienced an impact or has been subjected to a significant force, retire it immediately, even if there is no visible damage. Head protection is designed for single-use impact protection and may not retain its full effectiveness after an incident.

Worksite: _____ Instructor: _____ Date: _____

Attended by:

_____ _____ _____

_____ _____ _____

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